This gesture delighted the Goans.

Each of the Goan youngsters took home not just a visual memory but a beautiful certificate of gratitude given by the police. In many homes these certificates still stand displayed. Even the lieutenant governor of Goa, as if not to be left behind, sent an appreciation letter to the police.

Once CHOGM was over, Kiran rang up her house in Delhi, and her daughter Saina, also called Guchu, answered the phone. It was daytime and Kiran wondered why she had not gone to school. She replied, 'Mama, it's a holiday'. Kiran's mother came on the line and told her that she should return to attend to Guchu for she needed her total attention. She told her that all along, because of the exigencies of her work, they had held back the information on Guchu's deteriorating health from her but could not do so any longer. Guchu's nephritis had gone beyond control and she needed immediate hospitalization.

Kiran put in an application for leave on the ground that her daughter's condition had become serious. The leave was recommended by her IGP, Rajendra Mohan. The date of departure as requested in her application arrived, but there was no response from the Secretariat as yet. Meanwhile, she came to know that a particular BSF (Border Security Force) plane, which had flown in with the BSF equipment for the CHOGM arrangements, was flying straight back to Delhi. If the leave had been formally sanctioned, she could have gone on the same plane and saved three days and nights if she had to travel by train. She was out of money (as she had to maintain two establishments, not to mention the enormous medical expenditure) and so could not take a commercial flight. She was in mental agony as to how to reach her daughter, and decided not to wait for the clerical approval. She did not have the confidence that the IGP would have the courage to permit her to go despite his recommendations to the government. She decided to risk her posting in Goa and left for Delhi to face a tougher challenge: the risk to her daughter's life.

The Dornier aircraft in which she flew was piloted by Inspector-General (Air) Tarlok Singh Dhaliwal (now deceased), who was on CHOGM duty. Those five hours in the aircraft were long hours. Kiran reached home just after sunset. Guchu was excited to see her mother, totally unaware of what she was looking like. Her face was swollen and her stomach bloated; her face had a double chin and her eyes had become Mongoloid because of water retention and protein shortage in her body. Kiran took her straight to AIIMS (All India Institute of Medical Sciences), New Delhi, where she was admitted under the personal care of Dr Veena Kalra and Dr R. N. Srivastava, both specialists in nephrology. Kiran and her daughter stayed in hospital for a week, after which Guchu was allowed to return home. The child needed all possible care and her mother once again came just in time when she was needed the most.

Kiran sent a request for leave extension; instead of granting it, she was declared absconding and absent without leave. It seems the CM made a statement to the UNI (United News of India) in Goa. The UNI in Delhi got back to her and asked her what the matter was and whether she was really absconding. She told them that she certainly was not and explained the circumstances under which she was compelled to be with her daughter. She told them that if they wished they could come and see for themselves, and they did! On seeing her daughter's condition, the UNI, Delhi, wrote a strong rebuttal of the Goa CM's statement. It put the record straight, but it did expose the Goa administration, and made its members even more hostile towards Kiran. Now they refused to sanction any leave at all. Here is a news item which appeared in this context then:

LEAVE LANDS KIRAN IN TROUBLE